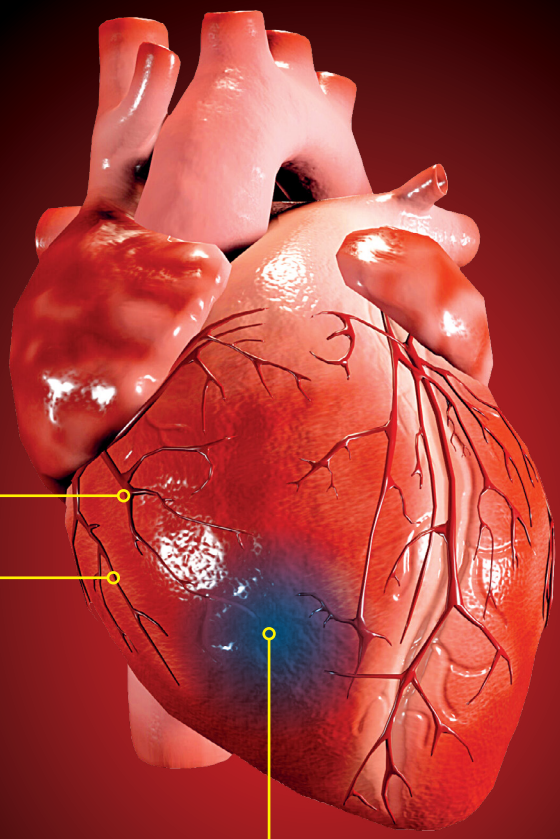
WHAT IS A SILENT HEART ATTACK?

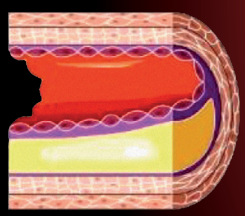
IT IS ONE THAT IS NOT ACCOMPANIED BY ANY SYMPTOMS, MILD SYMPTOMS OR SYMPTOMS THAT PEOPLE DON'T ASSOCIATE WITH A HEART ATTACK. DOCTORS OUTLINE THE DIFFERENT STAGES OF SUCH A HEART ATTACK

By SONALI ACHARJEE
Graphic by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY



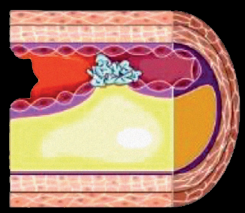
STAGE 1

Your heart muscles need a constant flow of oxygenated blood to survive. Sometimes coronary arteries that supply blood to the heart muscle become narrow due to fat or cholesterol build-up that is called plaque



STAGE 2

When this plaque breaks, a blood clot forms around it. This clot can restrict the flow of blood through the artery to the heart, a condition called ischemia



STAGE 3

Ischemia results when the heart muscle is starved of oxygen and nutrients



STAGE 4

When damage or death of part of the heart muscle occurs as a result of ischemia, it's classified as myocardial infarction (MI), or what is commonly known as a heart attack



STAGE 5

The first 60 minutes, also called the golden hour, are crucial after an attack. Blood supply should be restored as soon as possible to save the heart muscle and prevent death



You may be having a heart attack if you...



Feel like you have the flu



Have a sore muscle in your chest or upper back



Have an ache in your jaw, arms or upper back



Feel very tired



Have indigestion